whole of Persia Sir Jack McDonalds. There are others the authors of which I forget, but you will soon find out if you inquire. Ignorance about the last does not appear to me to be any shame to a man at the present time for I have heard of a member of Parliament saying in his place "that it was a shame that we had no Consul at Trebizonde *on the Danube*" and Lord Palmerston[46] who ought to have known better, *wrote* "that the trade between England and Persia never would be great because it had to be carried on thro' *Erzeroum in Russia.*" So altho it does not appear that a well informed man is expected to be so about these countries I should wish you to know something about them, because then I should be able to correspond with you upon subjects which I can not now.

In a few days I intend to leave this for Soub Bulock, the place where the galls come from. The people there are all Koords a wild people but they have been very kind to me on more than one occasion, I am going there to endeavour to buy galls on credit to send up against Charles' goods, which I hope must now be pretty near this and as the carriage is now low to Trebizonde I hope that these galls will answer well as a remittance, at any rate I have every prospect of getting them cheaper than my neighbours have been buying them here. I shall most probably be about 20 days away but this must be determined by the letters which I hope to receive from Charles by the courier who is now nine days past due. Once when I was at Soub Bulock before I was out hog hunting with the Koords and very fine sport it was. People who have tried both, say that it is better than fox hunting. If I have any sport of this kind I will send you an account of my exploits.

The dispute between the Shah and Mr McNeill is I think most likely to be arranged amicably but Mr McNeill has not yet received the answers to his letters.[47] Now pray do not alarm yourselves about the dangerous state of Persia, I assure you there is nothing in it. I believe that people run more risks of their lives from broken limbs in England than we do here, witness dear Fathers horrible accident last spring. The first news I had of this was in a letter from Bonham which I received in Teheran which said "your father has recovered from his accident and has gone into the country."

The winter has been rather severe the thermometer frequently standing at 6 and even 10 below zero and the snow which now lies on the ground and has been deep has brought down quantities of hares from the mountains. I have not been out shooting for the last fortnight because the last time I was out I sprained my knee and Dr Riach told me to walk as little as possible.

46 British Foreign Minister.

47 The immediate cause for this dispute was the insult and injury done to a native courier of the ambassador. The Shah was at the moment engaged in a siege against Herat, aided and abetted by the Russians, a project which the British viewed with alarm as an ultimate threat to India.

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